



Establish and maintain quality control in food production

D1.HCC.CL2.02

Assessor Manual



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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An introduction for assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes
- Case Studies

- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes
- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal

- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Prior to the assessment I have:		
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - a) *Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - b) *At 'X' location*
 - c) *You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
- You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment

- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.
There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.
We have 60 minutes for this assessment.
 - I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering 'Remarks' as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of 'Written Questions' for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):

"These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?"

- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency Standard

UNIT TITLE: ESTABLISH AND MAINTAIN QUALITY CONTROL IN FOOD PRODUCTION		NOMINAL HOURS: 35
UNIT NUMBER: D1.HCC.CL2.02		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required by cooks and chefs in a supervisor position to establish and maintain quality control of food production in commercial food environments		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Establish quality control in food production 1.1 Identify appropriate <i>quality standards</i> in <i>food production</i> 1.2 Develop appropriate <i>quality procedures</i> to maintain quality Element 2: Implement and monitor quality control procedures in food production 2.1 Ensure that <i>quality procedures</i> are implemented 2.2 Verify products produced are in-line with established <i>quality standards</i> Element 3: Review quality control procedures in food production 3.1 Identify <i>problems</i> that may occur 3.2 Solve <i>problems</i> that may occur		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment This unit applies to all industry sectors that are responsible for establishing and maintaining high quality food production within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: - Food Production. <i>Quality standards</i> may be related to: - Raw materials - Cooking processes - Portion control - Re-thermalisation - Standard recipes - Menu listings - Food handling.

	<i>Food production</i> may be related to: • Room service • Functions • Buffet service • Bistro service • A la carte style service • In house or outside catering. <i>Quality procedures</i> may be related to: • Formal audits • Feedback from colleagues and customers • Reviews of costs and revenues. <i>Problems</i> may relate to : • Product quality • Processes • Customer expectations. Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Knowledge of the enterprise's policies and procedures in regard to quality • Demonstrated ability to establish, implement and maintain quality control systems in a commercial kitchen • Knowledge of quality systems and options suitable for a commercial cookery or catering enterprise.
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	Linkages To Other Units • Comply with workplace hygiene procedures • Implement occupational health and safety procedures • Prepare and store food • Work effectively with colleagues and customers • Maintain strategies for safe food storage • Present and display food products • Apply basic techniques of commercial cookery • Prepare a variety of sandwiches • Prepare stock and sauces • Prepare soups • Prepare vegetables, eggs and farinaceous dishes • Identify and prepare various meats • Prepare and cook poultry and game meats • Prepare and cook seafood. Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Knowledge of quality as it relates to food production • Ability to identify quality standards that relate to raw materials, cooking processes and menu items • Demonstrated ability to identify a range of quality procedures to be applied to a food production area • Demonstrated ability to solve quality problems identified in a food production area.
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	Context of Assessment This unit may be assessed on or off the job • Assessment should include practical demonstration either in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge • Assessment must relate to the individuals work area or area of responsibility • Demonstration of skills on more than one occasion • Commercial food preparation area with relevant equipment. Resource Implications Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated workplace and use of a fully equipped commercial kitchen, use of real ingredients and service equipment; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines and tools. Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Case studies • Observation of practical candidate performance • Oral and written questions • Portfolio evidence • Problem solving • Role plays • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work.
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	Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Conduct audits and complete reports; implement changes as a result of audits and reports
	Communicating ideas and information	1	Receive, follow and give instructions about quality; communicate with colleagues; provide information about quality systems
	Planning and organising activities	2	Plan, organise and prioritise work tasks and responsibilities
	Working with others and in teams	2	Work cooperatively with colleagues in implementing quality systems; clarify personal responsibilities; deal with conflicts and misunderstandings; work out solutions in consultation with others
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	1	Calculate ratios of satisfaction; summarise audit responses
	Solving problems	2	Deal with quality or service breakdowns
	Using technology	1	Use calculators or computer-based systems to record information

Oral Questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Establish and maintain quality control in food production D1.HCC.CL2.02
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. How do you identify appropriate quality standards in food production? What factors do you take into account?	☐	☐
2. Give three examples of quality procedures you have developed to maintain quality in food production at your workplace.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. How do you monitor quality control procedures established for your workplace to ensure they are actually being implemented by staff?	☐	☐
4. Give three examples of how you have verified food products produced in your workplace are in-line with established quality standards.	☐	☐
5. Give two examples of food production quality problems you have identified in your workplace: what were the problems and how did you identify them?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. For the two examples provided in your answer to the previous questions, what did you do to effectively solve those problems?	☐	☐

Written Questions

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Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What are the four basic elements in the management of QC?

2. Why is it important to involve and consider the customer when determining and defining quality standards?

3. List four reasons why organisations use/adopt QC in their businesses.

4. Give three reasons 'taste' is included as a QC standard in food production.

5. Apart from 'taste' and 'standard recipes' identify eight other standards which may be identified for QC in food production.

6. Give four reasons businesses use standard recipes to assist with food quality standards.

7. Who should be involved in developing quality standards for a venue?

8. Identify four areas about which management at a venue is likely to have a perspective in relation to 'quality'.

9. Describe three general requirements regarding quality procedures established by the kitchen in relation to food production.

10. Name three quality procedures which may apply to 'taste' quality standards.

11. Name three quality procedures which may apply to 'temperature' quality standards.

12. How does the use of 'purchase specifications' support QC in food production?

13. Describe three QC procedures which may apply to cooking processes in food production.

14. List three QC procedures which may apply to equipment maintenance and service in food production.

15. If a dish becomes 'too expensive' what action might you take to address this situation while maintaining food quality standards?

16. Identify ten areas relating to food safety and food handling which should be addressed by QC procedures.

17. List the seven steps identified in the manual which need to be taken to support the introduction and implementation of quality procedures in the workplace.

18. Identify ten strategies to assist in introducing quality standards and procedures into standard workplace practice.

19. List five requirements which apply to the use of observing staff practices as a means of ensuring the agreed quality procedures are being implemented and have been integrated into SOPs for the kitchen.

20. List four practices which can be a focus for the use of workplace inspection checklists when seeking to ensure QC procedures are being implemented in the kitchen.

21. List four activities involved in seeking feedback from staff in relation to the implementation of workplace QC procedures.

22. Identify three opportunities which exist to obtain feedback from staff on implementation of QC procedures for food production.

23. Identify three opportunities which exist to obtain feedback from customers on implementation of QC procedures for food production.

24. Give three examples of the inspection of certain documentation which can help check implementation of quality procedures in food production.

25. Identify three options for testing staff as part of the process of ensuring QC procedures for food production are being implemented.

26. What should occur when testing of product reveals a significant variation from the relevant standard?

27. When testing products for conformity with standards, should every product be tested, every time? Discuss.

28. Explain what is meant by 'objective' and 'subjective' assessment when checking products and give two examples of each.

29. Identify three documents which should be provided to those who will be responsible for testing to see if food items meet the quality standards site for them.

30. Identify the three generic practices which will enable qualitative analysis of food items.

31. Identify five practices which will enable quantitative analysis of food items.

32. What is 'plate waste analysis' and why is it done?

33. Give two reasons why a venue might use 'laboratory analysis' when testing the quality of finished food products.

34. Give five reasons the review process is necessary for QC in food production.

35. Before a review of QC standards and procedures occurs what four preparations for the review should you undertake?

36. What is identified in the notes as 'the critical aspect underpinning all reviews'?

37. When analysing evidence as part of reviewing QC procedures, what are the two aims of this process?

38. Identify three reasons there should be discussion among stakeholders as part of the process when reviewing QC procedures.

39. List five possible causes for taste-related problems with the quality of a dish which has been tested.

40. List three possible causes of meals failing to be produced within the required timeframe as part of a QC check/review.

41. What four things must you ensure when developing solutions to solve problems relating to QC issues?

42. Identify three actions you would/should take after developing a solution to an identified QC-related food problem.

43. List ten generic examples of solutions which may be required to address/solve identified QC problems in food production.

Answers to Written Questions

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The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

- 1. What are the four basic elements in the management of QC?**
 - Establishing quality standards
 - Implementing QC procedures to achieve the quality standards which have been developed
 - Monitoring of the QC procedures and quality standards which have been identified
 - Reviewing the established QC procedures and quality standards.
- 2. Why is it important to involve and consider the customer when determining and defining quality standards?**
 - Every customer is an individual – with individual tastes, perceptions and references
 - Customer definitions of ‘quality’ change over time – as they grow, gain experience and change
 - The customer decides what quality is.
- 3. List four reason organisations use/adopt QC in their businesses.**
 - Identify and meet customer expectations
 - Deliver a consistent standard or food to customers
 - Allows customers to depend on the quality they will receive and therefore have confidence in what they will be served
 - Optimises repeat and referral business
 - Increase levels of compliance with legal requirements as they apply to food safety and safe food handling practices
 - Reduce number of complaint and enhances customer satisfaction levels
 - Verify the standards of dishes produced and served
 - Enhance the viability of the business
 - Give staff a feeling of pride in their work and their workplace
 - Keep promises about food made to customers in the advertising and promotion the venue undertakes.

4. **Give three reasons 'taste' is included as a QC standard in food production.**
 - Ensure consistency of flavour
 - Avoid off tastes
 - Meet customer expectations about flavours of classical dishes
 - Provide a point of difference between your venue and the kitchens of other venues.
5. **Apart from 'taste' and 'standard recipes' identify eight other standards which may be identified for QC in food production.**
 - Temperature
 - Raw materials
 - Cooking processes
 - Knowledge and skills of staff
 - Nutrition
 - Volume
 - Equipment maintenance and service
 - Speed of service
 - Price
 - Portion control
 - Re-thermalisation
 - Plating and presentation
 - Menu listings and descriptions
 - Variety and choice
 - Food handling and food safety.
6. **Give four reasons businesses use standard recipes to assist with food quality standards.**
 - Maintain a consistent quality of each dish
 - Establish the food cost for each menu item so an appropriate selling price can be calculated
 - Control the portion size
 - Establish the food cost percentage for each menu item
 - Enable accurate food orders to be written
 - Assist with training new staff in preparing the dish.
7. **Who should be involved in developing quality standards for a venue?**
 - Customers
 - Management
 - A 'Quality Management Team'.

- 8. Identify four areas about which management at a venue is likely to have a perspective in relation to 'quality'.**
- Decreased wastage
 - Increased productivity
 - Reduced energy costs/usage
 - Higher sales
 - Lower levels of complaints
 - Better profits
 - Enhanced compliance with legislated obligations
 - More yield.
- 9. Describe three general requirements regarding quality procedures established by the kitchen in relation to food production.**
- Comply with legislated food safety requirements
 - Relate directly to the quality standards which have been identified
 - Be practical and able to be implemented
 - Be able to be monitored and evaluated.
- 10. Name three quality procedures which may apply to 'taste' quality standards.**
- Need to follow the standard recipe for the dish to be prepared
 - Need to taste test every dish prepared in the kitchen
 - Need to discard suspect or non-compliant dishes
 - Need for a stipulated number of people to taste a dish.
- 11. Name three quality procedures which may apply to 'temperature' quality standards.**
- Need to prepare serving dishes/plates prior to service – such as:
 - Pre-warming plates for hot food
 - Pre-chilling plates/bowls for cold foods
 - Requirement à la carte foods are served within a certain time after having been prepared:
 - 'Immediately'
 - 'Within 60 seconds'
 - Requirement all foods are served within a nominated time – after having been plated
 - All foods not conforming with the stated requirements/criteria are discarded
 - Use of a food thermometer to temperature test food.

12. How does the use of 'purchase specifications' support QC in food production?

Controls/defines the quality of certain ingredients bought from suppliers to help ensure their consistency and suitability for their anticipated use.

13. Describe three QC procedures which may apply to cooking processes in food production.

- The cooking process for a menu item as stated in the standard recipe is the only process which can be used – no alternatives may be used
- Prescribed cooking equipment are the only items which can be used in the cooking process for nominated dishes – as identified in the Standard Recipe
- Prescribed utensils must be used as part of the cooking process
- Descriptors for and cooking times applicable to, steaks (such as blue, rare, medium-rare, medium, well done).

14. List three QC procedures which may apply to equipment maintenance and service in food production.

- Scheduling the servicing of items – to provide preventative maintenance aimed at keeping items performing at their optimal level and preventing breakdowns which will impact on food quality of final product
- Taking defective equipment out of service – to avoid situations where food is not subject to required performance/processing by equipment
- Regular testing and/or inspection of equipment – to verify operational effectiveness or to identify problems at the earliest opportunity
- Need to adhere to 'manufacturer's instructions' – when providing maintenance and repairs.

15. If a dish becomes 'too expensive' what action might you take to address this situation while maintaining food quality standards?

- Down-size the portion served
- Remove the item from the menu.

16. Identify ten areas relating to food safety and food handling which should be addressed by QC procedures.

- Receiving of food into the premises
 - Storing of food after it has been received – covering:
 - Refrigerated food
 - Frozen food
 - Dry goods
- Food preparation
- Food processing
- Displaying hot and cold food

- Packaging of food for take away sales and service
- Service of food
- Transportation of food – where applicable
- Cleaning and sanitation of food areas, equipment, utensils and food contact surfaces
- Staff uniforms
- Personal hygiene
- Pest control
- Prevention of contamination of foodstuffs and food surfaces – including prevention of cross contamination.

17. List the seven steps identified in the manual which need to be taken to support the introduction and implementation of quality procedures in the workplace.

- Confirm with customers your standards reflect their needs, wants and preferences
- Obtain management approval
- Prepare written standards
- Develop written procedures
- Integrate the quality standards and procedures – into SOPs for the kitchen
- Establish monitoring protocols
- Develop review procedures.

18. Identify ten strategies to assist in introducing quality standards and procedures into standard workplace practice.

- Explain the need for the quality standards and practices which have been developed – by highlighting the benefits of adhering to the requirements which flow to customers, the venue and the job security of every kitchen staff member
- Detail the process which was followed to generate the quality standards and practices – so staff understand their importance, how they were arrived at and the way in which they align with customer and venue imperatives
- Prepare, arrange and/or obtain the necessary resources (as required to suit individual venues needs) to enable/support implementation of the required quality procedures – and advise staff of their availability and their access to them
- Share the quality standards and practices with staff – this may involve:
 - Handing out hard copies
 - Posting copies in the workplace
 - Loading them onto the venue intranet
 - Including them into SOP manuals and Staff Handbooks
 - Develop and share Standard Recipes – for all identified dishes

- Tell staff you will be checking to ensure quality procedures are being implemented and quality standards are being met – and advise them of the practices you intend using to do this so they are prepared for ‘new’ supervisory activities in this regard
- Generate colour photographs of all finished meals – for use within Standard Recipe sheets/cards and for use as guides when plating meals
- Verify all menu descriptions for dishes are correct – when compared to the Standard Recipe cards for each menu item
- Conduct relevant on-the-job and/or external, formal training – for all kitchen staff, which must address both knowledge and skills in relation to:
 - Practical training in food production
 - Demonstrations of plating and serving techniques and requirements
 - Instruction on the use of food display equipment and food service utensils (service items and service/tableware)
- Testing staff – to:
 - Assess their competency in relation to quality control in food production
 - Serve as the basis for extra/top-up training
- Include required information regarding established quality standards and practices into:
 - Induction and Orientation programmes for new kitchen staff
 - In-house training for kitchen employees
- Update venue policy and procedures manuals – to include quality-related details
- Generate a range of workplace posters – which can be posted throughout the kitchen to remind staff of what is required and which can serve as a reminder/prompt for required action
- Develop a range of checklists – which can be used to:
 - Monitor implementation of the agreed quality standards and procedures
 - Inspect the workplace for compliance with specified requirements
 - Measure and assess the physical elements of menu items which have been produced.

19. List five requirements which apply to the use of observing staff practices as a means of ensuring the agreed quality procedures are being implemented and have been integrated into SOPs for the kitchen.

Observation of this type must:

- Be spread evenly amongst all staff – to ensure individual staff do not feel victimised
- Address all quality standards – as identified to staff
- Cover all quality procedures – which have been established and communicated to staff
- Monitor all types of service sessions – as provided by the venue
- Focus on all food items being produced – which are subject to quality standards and procedures

- Be ongoing in nature – as opposed to sporadic
- Be recorded – so the record (such as a completed checklist, or personal notes written at the time of observation) can form the basis of later feedback to staff
- Result in remedial action – where issues have been identified and/or instances of non-compliance are noted
- Never allow identified non-compliance to go un-addressed
- Form the basis of additional action consolidate the concept of quality control in the workplace – additional action may require you to:
 - Demonstrate practices
 - Explain concepts/requirements
 - Provide/arrange for extra training
 - Re-locate staff to different roles – where they are unable to perform as required.

20. List four practices which can be a focus for the use of workplace inspection checklists when seeking to ensure QC procedures are being implemented in the kitchen.

- Food production procedures
- Ordering of meals and lodgement of orders with the kitchen
- Cleaning and sanitation
- Food storage, display and service
- Stock purchasing, rotation and control.

21. List four activities involved in seeking feedback from staff in relation to the implementation of workplace QC procedures.

- Asking for it
- Thanking staff for contributing it
- Never ‘shooting the messenger’ – that is, not blaming the person who gives you ‘bad news’
- Adopting a ‘no blame’ policy – meaning staff are not blamed if they make a mistake/do something wrong but tell you honestly what they did/failed to do (so you can determine if the problem lies with the procedure or the staff member)
- Factoring in the input received into future action – to address issues and/or re-affirm procedures.

22. Identify three opportunities which exist to obtain feedback from staff on implementation of QC procedures for food production.

- Casual conversations with staff as you walk around the kitchen and interact with staff
- At regular staff meetings
- As part of the day-to-day staff briefings (at the start of the shift) and at the staff de-briefings (when the shift has finished)
- Having an 'open door' policy towards 'quality' – meaning you are always available to discuss any issue associated with quality standards, procedures, problems or issues.

23. Identify three opportunities which exist to obtain feedback from customers on implementation of QC procedures for food production.

- Talking with customers – for example:
 - As part of the 'three-minute check'
 - When they depart at the end of a meal
- Offering 'Customer Comment Cards' to customers – on departure/at the end of the meal and encouraging them to complete and submit them
- Including a 'Contact Us'/'Customer Feedback' section on your venue website
- Using focus groups
- Reading complaints and compliments forwarded to the venue.

24. Give three examples of the inspection of certain documentation which can help check implementation of quality procedures in food production.

- Analysing food processing logs – which record actions, times and temperatures for the production of certain food items.
FSPs usually have a standard requirement these details must be recorded (for example) for one dish at least weekly or every fortnight
- Verifying food safety records as required by your FSP have been completed as required – these records may relate to:
 - Temperatures of refrigeration units
 - Inspection of food deliveries into the premises
 - Inspections of food and food areas
- Food production records – detailing the foods which have been produced by type, date, time and volume
- Corrective Action Reports – to identify the remedial/corrective action taken by staff when they identify a quality problem or out-of-control (food safety) situation
- Delivery dockets and invoices from suppliers – to verify the required type, brand, volumes, quality and grades of food are being ordered to meet the needs of Standard Recipes.

25. Identify three options for testing staff as part of the process of ensuring QC procedures for food production are being implemented.

- Formal testing – using:
 - Written questions
 - Standardised trade testing (practical assessments).
- Informal testing – such as:
 - Oral questions
 - Posing simulated quality issues (or case studies) to staff and asking them to address/resolve them.

26. What should occur when testing of product reveals a significant variation from the relevant standard?

- Where testing identifies significant variance from the established standards, action must be taken to either;
 - Address the process which is the cause of the variance, and/or
 - Modify the standard so there is alignment between the product and standard.

27. When testing products for conformity with standards, should every product be tested, every time? Discuss.

All products produced must be tested – usual practice is to test products on a cyclical basis where, at the end of a given period (for example, 12 months), all food products have been tested rather than testing every product, every time.

28. Explain what is meant by ‘objective’ and ‘subjective’ assessment when checking products and give two examples of each.

- Objective and subjective assessment:
 - Objective assessment refers to statistical data of the dish – such as weight, size, volume, temperature, time taken to produce, ingredients used
 - Subjective assessment refers to personal evaluation of factors such as taste, eye appeal, texture and aroma.

29. Identify three documents which should be provided to those who will be responsible for testing to see if food items meet the quality standards site for them.

- Product standards
- Standard Recipes
- Record assessment sheets for the items to be tested/checked.

30. Identify the three generic practices which will enable qualitative analysis of food items.

- Visually appraising the dish
- Nosing the dish
- Tasting the dish.

31. Identify five practices which will enable quantitative analysis of food items.

- Determining or otherwise quantifying the serve size or portion size of the dish
- Determining wait time/preparation time for the dish
- Assessing garnishing for the meal
- Taking the temperature of the dish
- Deconstructing dishes
- Comparing the dish 'as presented' against the description of the dish on the menu.

32. What is 'plate waste analysis' and why is it done?

- Plate waste analysis – this is analysis of food returned from the table/guests when they have finished their meal to determine:
 - If there is a quality-related problem with these items
 - Whether or not customer tastes/preferences are changing.

33. Give two reasons a venue might use 'laboratory analysis' when testing the quality of finished food products.

- Laboratory analysis – external examinations can be conducted and reports generated by providers in relation to:
 - Analysis of food – to determine nutritional content
 - Bacterial swabs – to determine the type and level of microbiological contaminants in the kitchen.

34. Give five reasons the review process is necessary for QC in food production.

- Because QC in food production is a dynamic process – it is constantly changing and what applied 'yesterday' will not necessarily apply 'tomorrow'
- To ensure the quality standards which are applied are still important to customers – and do not relate to dated needs, wants and preferences
- To confirm, where appropriate, established quality standards and procedures remain applicable and relevant
- To determine the need for changes to be made – to quality standards and quality procedures
- To demonstrate/prove to staff the venue's ongoing interest in and commitment to quality
- To accommodate the findings of quality-related monitoring/testing activities
- To re-set/re-frame quality standards and procedures on the basis of actual evidence – as opposed simple 'beliefs'.

35. Before a review of QC standards and procedures occurs what four preparations for the review should you undertake?

- Schedule review sessions
- Remind the Quality Management Team of the review and notify them regarding:
 - Time, date and venue for the review
 - The need for their involvement
 - Topics/issues to be addressed
- Read all relevant documentation (standards, procedures, standard recipes, audits, workplace inspections and checklists as well as assessment reports and feedback forms) so you are fully aware of all relevant issues to be considered as part of the review process
- Distribute all documentation to those who will be involved in the review process.

36. What is identified in the notes as ‘the critical aspect underpinning all reviews’?

You can demonstrate/provide evidence of the problem – this is the critical aspect underpinning all reviews: you must be able to prove there actually is a problem and be able to demonstrate what it is.

37. When analysing evidence as part of reviewing QC procedures, what are the two aims of this process?

- Establish the nature of the relationship between ‘cause’ and ‘outcome’ – so the link between ‘the problem’ and what caused it can be expressly defined
- Determine whether or not the problem lies with the quality standard and/or with the quality procedure.

38. Identify three reasons there should be discussion among stakeholders as part of the process when reviewing QC procedures.

- Agree on the type and nature of the problem – so the problem can be adequately described
- Confirm the ‘issue’ is, in fact, a problem – and not just an anomaly
- Reach consensus there is need for change – to verify action being considered is not an over-reaction to the situation
- Verify the credibility, interpretation and validity of the evidence – which is being used as the basis for the review
- Determine if existing standards and procedures need to be ‘revised’ – or whether there is a need to develop totally new standards and/or quality procedures.

39. List five possible causes for taste-related problems with the quality of a dish which has been tested.

- An inappropriate standard recipe
- Failure to follow the recipe
- Use of incorrect ingredients

- Inclusion of out-of-date, contaminated or otherwise unacceptable ingredients and/or substitutions for specified ingredients
- Incorrect cooking style
- Improper cooking technique
- Excessive (or insufficient) cooking times and temperatures
- Failing to taste dishes throughout the preparation process
- Poor re-heating practices
- Ineffective food holding practices.

40. List three possible causes of meals failing to be produced within the required timeframe as part of a QC check/review.

- Insufficient staff
- Lack of proper training
- Insufficient equipment
- Poor/ineffective ordering placement systems
- Lack of communication in the kitchen – between kitchen staff and/or between kitchen and wait staff.

41. What four things must you ensure when developing solutions to solve problems relating to QC issues?

- Ensure solutions developed:
 - Address the cause of the problem – and not (just) a symptom of it
 - Do not create another problem/issue – when the solution is implemented
 - Align with customer needs, wants and preferences – as opposed to imposing unwanted changed quality elements on them
 - Are viable and practicable – so the decision reached and revised (or new) standards and procedures can actually be implemented as intended.

42. Identify three actions you would/should take after developing a solution to an identified QC-related food problem.

- Confirm with stakeholders (staff, customers and management) the new/revised standards and/or procedures align with their needs, wants and preferences
- Develop written revised or new quality standards and/or procedures as required
- Integrate revised/new protocols and requirements into SOPs and internal training
- Provide necessary resources to enable attainment of new/revised standards and/or the implementation of new/revised procedures.

43. List ten generic examples of solutions which may be required to address/solve identified QC problems in food production.

- Re-write the quality standard for individual food items
 - Revise existing and/or introduce new quality procedures
 - Re-write the Standard Recipe
 - Service equipment
 - Change internal systems
 - Revise purchasing protocols
 - Implement training of staff
 - Allocate more money
 - Changing portion sizes
 - Altering menus
 - Re-vamping safe food handling protocols
 - Alter holding and presentation protocols for food
 - Increase frequency of:
 - Testing and assessment of products
 - Workplace observation
 - Targeted inspections
 - Reviews
 - Modify focus of workplace, QC-related activities – such as:
 - Adding new areas as a focus for workplace inspections
 - Market research activities to obtain customer feedback.
-

Observation Checklist

Student name			
Assessor name			
Location/venue			
Unit of competency	Establish and maintain quality control in food production D1.HCC.CL2.02		
Dates of observation			
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Establish quality control in food production - Implement and monitor quality control procedures in food production - Review quality control procedures in food production - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.		
Did the candidate	Yes	No	
Element 1: Establish quality control in food production			
Identify appropriate quality standards in food production	☐	☐	
Develop appropriate quality procedures to maintain quality	☐	☐	
Element 2: Implement and monitor quality control procedures in food production			
Ensure that quality procedures are implemented	☐	☐	
Verify products produced are in-line with established quality standards	☐	☐	
Element 3: Review quality control procedures in food production			
Identify problems that may occur	☐	☐	
Solve problems that may occur	☐	☐	
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐	

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor
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Improvements needed:

General comments:

Candidate signature

Date

Assessor signature

Date

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other <i>Please specify: _____</i> <i>Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]</i>		
Unit of competency:	Establish and maintain quality control in food production D1.HCC.CL2.02		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Establishes workplace quality control for food production identifying and developing appropriate quality standards	☐	☐	☐
Monitors established quality control protocols ensuring quality procedures are implemented	☐	☐	☐
Verifies food produced aligns with established quality standards	☐	☐	☐
Reviews established quality control procedures identifying and solving problems that may occur	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:

Third party signature:

Date:

Send to:

Competency Recording Sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Establish and maintain quality control in food production	D1.HCC.CL2.02
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Establish quality control in food production						
Identify appropriate quality standards in food production						
Develop appropriate quality procedures to maintain quality						
Element 2: Implement and monitor quality control procedures in food production						
Ensure that quality procedures are implemented						
Verify products produced are in-line with established quality standards						
Element 3: Review quality control procedures in food production						
Identify problems that may occur						
Solve problems that may occur						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

